

Cavalry Equipment

Although sabers and other traditional cavalry weapons were still issued, the Civil War saw mounted troops on both sides depend increasingly on firearms. The men often dismounted to fight, but also used new multiple-shot breechloading carbines from the saddle.



❶ Morse carbine (Confederate) Around 1,000 were produced by the State Military Works in Greenville, South Carolina.



❷ Henry rifle (Union) It could hold 15 .44-caliber rimfire cartridges. Much prized for its rapid rate of fire, it was purchased by Union military units.



❸ Spencer carbine (Union) First issued in the later part of 1863; the Federal government purchased more than 95,000.